

The Ultimate IELTS Writing Error Book

This guide consolidates all your notes, feedback, and logs into a single, actionable system for eliminating errors and achieving a high score.

Part 1: The Core Principles (Your Guiding Rules)

These foundational rules are critical to your success. Review them before every practice session.

- **The "25-Word Max" Iron Law:** Break complex ideas into shorter, clearer sentences to maintain grammatical control and accuracy in both Task 1 and Task 2.
- **The "Chart ID Card" (Task 1):** Take 10 seconds to confirm the chart's identity:
 - What is the Topic?
 - What is the Unit (% , numbers, \$, growth rate)?
 - What are the Time/Categories?This prevents fatal misinterpretations.
- **The "30-Second Final Check":** Prioritize checking:
 - Your Calculations: Verify sums, differences, or multiples.
 - Keyword Spelling: Check key nouns from the prompt (e.g., Copper, government).
- **The Strict Four-Paragraph Rule (Task 2):** Structure Task 2 essays as: Introduction, Body Paragraph 1, Body Paragraph 2, and Conclusion. Do not use a separate "Overall" paragraph.

Part 2: Task 1 Diagnostic & Error Log

This section combines Task 1 feedback into a targeted diagnostic tool.

Category 1: Task Achievement "Fatal Flaws"

These errors can instantly lower your score.

Flaw Type	 My Common Error	 Correct Approach	 Mental Rule
Y-Axis Misinterpretation	Reading "annual growth" as "total population."	Accurately describe the unit, e.g., "population growth."	Chart ID Card: Always confirm the Y-axis unit before writing. Is it a number, a percentage, or a rate of change?

Flaw Type	✗ My Common Error	✓ Correct Approach	🧠 Mental Rule
Calculation Errors	Incorrectly calculating a 4.6x difference as 7x.	Use a calculator during practice to verify. $176k \div 38k \approx 4.6$ times.	30-Second Check: Re-calculate any figures you've derived yourself.
Subjective Inference	Adding personal analysis like, "...which shows its demand may be the largest."	Stick to facts: "...which was the highest growth rate of the three."	The Golden Rule: Only answer "What do I see?" Never answer "Why did this happen?" Describe, don't explain.

Category 2: Grammar & Structure "Stubborn Enemies"

These recurring structural problems harm clarity.

Enemy Type	✗ My Common Error	✓ Correct Approach	🧠 Mental Rule
"Monster" Sentences	Combining 3+ data points into one 50-word sentence, causing confusion.	Limit each sentence to 1-2 key pieces of information.	The "25-Word Max" Iron Law: Non-negotiable for Task 1. Forces clarity and prevents grammatical collapse.
Sentence Fragments	Which became the highest... or Showing major influence... as standalone sentences.	..., which became the highest. or ..., showing major influence.	The Train Hook Rule: Which and -ing clauses are train cars, not engines. They must be hooked to a main sentence with a comma.
Incorrect Tense (Maps)	Using present tense for a past map (There are... for 1986).	Past Map: Use Past Simple (There were...). Present Map: Use Present Simple (There are...). The Change: Use Present Perfect (New houses have been built...).	The Time Traveler Rule: Describe each map in its own time. Use the perfect tense to connect past to present.
Incorrect Passive Voice	...will be shift to... or ...and being sent... or users...was accounted for...	...will be shifted to... and ...and are sent... and users...accounted for...	Passive Formula: be + past participle (p.p.). Remember that "account for" is an active verb phrase.

Category 3: Vocabulary "Precision Traps"

These word choice errors make your writing sound unnatural.

Trap Type	✗ My Common Error	✓ Correct / Better Version	🧠 Mental Rule
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Trap Type	❌ My Common Error	✅ Correct / Better Version	🧠 Mental Rule
Keyword Spelling	Cooper	Copper	30-Second Check: Always proofread keywords from the prompt itself.
Concept Word Confusion	the amount of meals (countable)	the number of meals	Amount: for uncountable nouns (water, time, money). Number: for countable nouns (people, cars, meals).
Unnatural Phrasing	major/minor influence, less a third of, users aging from...	the most/least popular, less than a third, users aged...	Read More, Invent Less: Absorb natural phrasing from high-scoring models rather than creating your own combinations.

Part 3: Task 2 Diagnostic & Error Log

This section focuses on the unique demands of structuring a formal academic essay.

Error Category	Sub-Type	❌ My Common Error	✅ Correct Approach & Rule
Essay Structure	Weak Introduction	Starting a separate "Overall" paragraph after the intro.	Integrate your thesis and outline into the final sentence(s) of your introduction. Rule: A Task 2 essay is four paragraphs, period.
Essay Structure	Unclear Topic Sentences	Vague sentence like: "There are many reasons for this."	Be specific: "The primary reason for this trend is accelerating economic development." Rule: The topic sentence must clearly state the main idea of the paragraph.
Content & Ideas	Lack of Support	Making a broad claim like: "Technology is bad for society."	Provide specific support: "Over-reliance on technology can harm society by, for instance, increasing social isolation." Rule: Every point must be supported by an explanation or example.
Vocabulary	Imprecise Word Choice	...constructive and fleshing events... or ...off-selling of this event...	...constructive and fresh events... or ...the non-commercial nature of this event... Rule: Proofread for typos and use standard academic vocabulary.
Vocabulary	Repetition	Overusing a key word like "freshness."	Introduce synonyms like novelty, appeal, or attractiveness. Rule: Vary your vocabulary to demonstrate a wider lexical resource.
Grammar	Word Form Confusion	...local residents loss motivations... or ...routine lives.	...local residents lose motivation... or ...routine lives . Rule: Loss is a noun; lose is a verb. Life is singular; lives is plural.



Part 4: Universal Sentence Control Toolkit

This is your reference guide for building correct and varied sentences.

The Building Blocks: Sentence Types

- **Simple Sentence:** One main idea.
Example: Technology improves communication.
- **Compound Sentence:** Two related main ideas joined by FANBOYS (For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So).
Example: Technology improves communication, so it enhances productivity.
- **Complex Sentence:** A main idea linked to a dependent idea with a subordinator (e.g., although, because, while, if).
Example: Although technology has many benefits, it also creates challenges.

Common Structural Faults & Fixes

Fault	Problem Example	 Solution
Run-on Sentence	Technology is important it helps people.	Add a Period: Technology is important. It helps people. OR Add a Conjunction: Technology is important because it helps people.
Sentence Fragment	Which is why technology is important.	Make it a full sentence: This is why technology is important. OR Attach it with a comma: ..., which is why technology is important.
Dangling Modifier	Walking to school, the weather was cold.	Clarify the subject: While I was walking to school, the weather was cold.

Punctuation Mastery

- **Comma (,):** Use with FANBOYS to connect two full sentences.
- **Semicolon (;):** Connects two closely related full sentences without a conjunction.
Example: Technology improves efficiency; it also reduces costs.
- **Colon (:):** Introduces a list or an explanation.
Example: Technology offers three main benefits: efficiency, connectivity, and innovation.



Part 5: Personal Spelling & Vocabulary Hit List

Review this prioritized list before every writing session to master common errors.

Critical Priority

Error Type	 My Error	 Correct Spelling	 Mental Rule
Persistent Spelling	colleges	colleagues	College = school. Colleagues = co-workers.
Persistent Spelling	it's (possessive)	its	It's only ever means it is. The possessive has no apostrophe.
Persistent Spelling	cooperations	corporations	Cooperation = working together. Corporation = a business.
Word Form	can recovered	can recover	After a modal verb (can, will, should), always use the base form.

High Priority

Error Type	 My Error	 Correct Spelling
Spelling	extremelly	extremely
Spelling	govenment	government
Spelling	efficent	efficient
Spelling	populaution	population
Spelling	dessert (the place)	desert
Word Choice	soar (for pain)	sore

Medium Priority

Error Type	 My Error	 Correct Spelling
Word Form	loss motivations	lose motivation
Word Form	new built	newly built
Word Form	loosing / lossing	losing
Word Form	strategies thinking	strategic thinking
Spelling	atractive	attractive
Spelling	accomodations	accommodations
Spelling	through out	throughout

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IELTS Writing Task 2: Argument Bank

Argument Categories

1. Education

Online Learning vs Traditional Education

- **Pros:** Flexibility, accessibility, cost-effective, global reach
- **Cons:** Lack of social interaction, self-discipline required, technical issues
- **Examples:** Coursera, edX, Khan Academy

Standardized Testing

- **Pros:** Fair assessment, measurable outcomes, accountability
- **Cons:** Stress, limited creativity, doesn't measure all skills
- **Examples:** SAT, IELTS, TOEFL

University vs Vocational Training

- **Pros of University:** Broad knowledge, critical thinking, research skills
 - **Pros of Vocational:** Practical skills, faster employment, lower cost
 - **Examples:** Apprenticeships, trade schools, community colleges
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2. Technology

Social Media Impact

- **Positive:** Global connectivity, information sharing, business opportunities
- **Negative:** Privacy concerns, mental health issues, misinformation
- **Examples:** Facebook, Instagram, TikTok

Artificial Intelligence

- **Benefits:** Efficiency, automation, medical advances, scientific research

- **Concerns:** Job displacement, ethical issues, bias, security risks
- **Examples:** ChatGPT, autonomous vehicles, medical diagnosis

Remote Work

- **Advantages:** Work-life balance, reduced commuting, global talent access
 - **Disadvantages:** Isolation, blurred boundaries, communication challenges
 - **Examples:** Zoom, Slack, Microsoft Teams
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3. Environment

Renewable Energy

- **Benefits:** Clean, sustainable, job creation, energy independence
- **Challenges:** High initial cost, intermittency, storage issues
- **Examples:** Solar panels, wind turbines, hydroelectric power

Plastic Pollution

- **Problems:** Marine life harm, human health risks, long decomposition
- **Solutions:** Biodegradable alternatives, recycling, government regulations
- **Examples:** Plastic bags, microplastics, ocean cleanup

Climate Change

- **Causes:** Fossil fuels, deforestation, industrial emissions
 - **Solutions:** Carbon pricing, renewable energy, sustainable practices
 - **Examples:** Paris Agreement, carbon taxes, green technology
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4. Health & Lifestyle

Fast Food vs Home Cooking

- **Fast Food:** Convenience, affordability, variety
- **Home Cooking:** Healthier, cost-effective, family bonding
- **Examples:** McDonald's, meal prep services, cooking classes

Exercise & Physical Activity

- **Benefits:** Physical health, mental well-being, social interaction
- **Barriers:** Time constraints, cost, lack of motivation

- **Examples:** Gym memberships, outdoor activities, team sports

Mental Health Awareness

- **Importance:** Reduced stigma, early intervention, better support
 - **Challenges:** Cultural barriers, limited resources, accessibility
 - **Examples:** Therapy, mindfulness apps, support groups
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5. Society & Culture

Globalization

- **Advantages:** Cultural exchange, economic growth, technological advancement
- **Disadvantages:** Cultural homogenization, economic inequality, job outsourcing
- **Examples:** International trade, cultural festivals, multinational companies

Urban vs Rural Living

- **Urban:** Job opportunities, amenities, cultural diversity
- **Rural:** Cleaner environment, community spirit, lower cost of living
- **Examples:** City centers, suburban areas, countryside communities

Traditional vs Modern Values

- **Traditional:** Cultural heritage, stability, community bonds
 - **Modern:** Progress, individual freedom, innovation
 - **Examples:** Family structures, gender roles, social norms
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Argument Construction Techniques

1. The PEEL Method

Point

- Make a clear, specific claim
- Example: "Technology has significantly improved healthcare outcomes."

Evidence

- Provide supporting facts, statistics, or examples
- Example: "Medical imaging technology has increased diagnostic accuracy by 40%."

Explanation

- Explain how the evidence supports your point
- Example: "This improvement allows doctors to detect diseases earlier, leading to better treatment outcomes."

Link

- Connect back to your main argument
 - Example: "Therefore, technological advancement in healthcare is essential for improving public health."
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2. Counter-Argument Strategy

Acknowledge Opposition

- Recognize the other side's perspective
- Example: "While some argue that technology reduces human interaction..."

Present Counter-Evidence

- Provide evidence against the opposition
- Example: "Research shows that technology actually enhances communication through various platforms."

Reinforce Your Position

- Strengthen your original argument
 - Example: "This demonstrates that technology can complement rather than replace human connection."
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IELTS Task 2 Argument Bank

This file stores powerful arguments and examples from practice essays that can be adapted for future topics.

Topic: Culture & Society (Museums / Local Tourism)

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Why don't local residents visit local cultural sites?

- **Argument 1: Proximity Breeds Indifference**

- **Explanation:** People are often more curious about unfamiliar, distant cultures than their own. The ease of access to local sites removes the feeling of excitement and novelty.
- **Supporting Example:** Residents of Taipei are less likely to visit the Taipei Fine Arts Museum because it is always available to them.

- **Argument 2: Over-Commercialization Deters Locals**

- **Explanation:** When historic sites become dominated by generic gift shops and markets aimed at tourists, they lose their authentic appeal for locals who can find similar goods elsewhere.
- **Supporting Example:** The Taipei Fine Arts Museum's gift shops sell common crafts that do not offer a unique experience for local citizens.

How can cultural sites attract more local visitors?

- **Solution: Host Unique, Non-Commercial Events**

- **Explanation:** Create fresh, exclusive experiences that focus on cultural engagement rather than sales. This builds a stronger community connection and provides a reason for locals to visit repeatedly.
- **Supporting Example:** The public interview with film director Wei Te-Sheng at the Taipei museum was a huge success because it was a unique, non-commercial event focused on local culture and history, drawing thousands of local attendees.



Supporting Evidence Types

1. Statistics & Data

- **Source:** Government reports, academic studies, surveys
- **Example:** "According to a 2023 study by the World Health Organization..."
- **Use:** When making quantitative claims

2. Expert Opinions

- **Source:** Researchers, professionals, authorities
- **Example:** "Dr. Smith, a leading expert in environmental science, argues..."
- **Use:** When discussing complex or specialized topics

3. Real-World Examples

- **Source:** Current events, case studies, personal observations
- **Example:** "The success of renewable energy in Denmark demonstrates..."
- **Use:** When illustrating abstract concepts

4. Historical Evidence

- **Source:** Past events, trends, patterns
 - **Example:** "Historical data shows that economic growth often follows..."
 - **Use:** When discussing long-term trends or patterns
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Language for Arguments

Expressing Opinions

- **Strong:** I firmly believe, I am convinced, It is clear that
- **Moderate:** I think, I believe, It seems that
- **Hedging:** It could be argued, Some people suggest, It is possible that

Presenting Evidence

- **Introducing:** Research shows, Studies indicate, Evidence suggests
- **Supporting:** This demonstrates, This proves, This indicates
- **Concluding:** Therefore, As a result, Consequently

Addressing Counter-Arguments

- **Acknowledging:** While some argue, Although it may seem, Despite claims
 - **Refuting:** However, Nevertheless, On the contrary
 - **Conceding:** It is true that, Admittedly, Granted
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Practice Topics

Easy Topics

1. "Do you agree that social media has more advantages than disadvantages?"

2. "Should students be required to wear school uniforms?"
3. "Is it better to live in the city or countryside?"

Medium Topics

1. "To what extent do you agree that technology makes people less social?"
2. "Should governments invest more in public transportation?"
3. "Do you think online shopping will replace traditional retail?"

Difficult Topics

1. "Some people believe that economic growth is more important than environmental protection. To what extent do you agree?"
 2. "Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of globalization on local cultures."
 3. "Should artificial intelligence be regulated by governments?"
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Tips for Success

1. Plan Before Writing

- Spend 5-10 minutes planning your essay
- Identify your position and main arguments
- Consider counter-arguments

2. Use Varied Language

- Avoid repetition
- Use synonyms and different sentence structures
- Include academic vocabulary

3. Support Every Claim

- Don't make statements without evidence
- Use examples, statistics, or expert opinions
- Explain how evidence supports your point

4. Consider Both Sides

- Even if you strongly agree/disagree, acknowledge other perspectives

- This shows critical thinking and balanced analysis
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